

4. Mirror cost across segmentation objectives

OUTPUT *Abstract.* Mirror cost measures the additional causal-LM bits per letter assigned to a reversed, re-segmented English stream relative to the same forward stream. We estimate it with matched forward/reverse treatment and report three deliberately different segmentation objectives: frequency-sensitive unigram segmentation, minimum-segment segmentation, and longest-word greedy segmentation. The question is not which objective recovers the true reading; it is whether the reverse penalty persists when the boundary preference changes.

CRITIQUE A result from one segmentation routine could be a property of that routine. Even three procedures can alter the magnitude materially, so the paper cannot hide the robustness analysis behind one headline average.

REVISION APPLIED Report the full per-objective ranges, explain the one-letter fallback, and interpret objective sensitivity as part of the finding rather than as noise to suppress.